VANCOUVER PUBLIC SCHOOLS

Legal Department

Notice

Updates to the following attached procedures have been approved by Superintendent, Jeff Snell, and are scheduled to be posted online at www.vansd.org

- Procedure 2410, Graduation Requirements
  - Posted on April 30, 2025

- Procedure 4130, Title I – Parental Involvement
  - Posted on April 30, 2025

Procedure - High School Graduation Requirements

I. Publication of Graduation Requirements

A. Starting in the eighth (8th) grade and each year thereafter, middle and high schools shall provide each student and parent/guardian with a copy of the high school graduation requirements applicable to each student. The school will also provide a progress report of each individual student's progress toward meeting those requirements at the close of each school year. If a student is not making normal progress toward such requirements, the high school shall notify the student and parent/guardian of alternative education experiences, including summer school opportunities available in the community, if any, or in close proximity (WAC 180-51-045).

B. Graduation requirements in effect when a student first attends high school shall be in effect until that student graduates. The student, however, shall have the right to graduate in accordance with the requirements in effect for the school for any year that the student is enrolled in high school.

II. General Requirements for Annual Enrollment -- Grades 9-12

A. Full-time enrollment required: unless prior approval from the principal or designee, a student will be enrolled in no less than six (6) subjects each semester.

B. At least three (3) academic subjects are recommended for study each semester.

C. "Academic" subject defined: a subject which calls upon use of the combined skills of rationalization - reading and analyzing - and of writing, as requisites of the learning process.

D. One (1) period of early release or late arrival may be granted by the building principal on an exception only basis. This option will be limited to twelfth (12th) grade students.

E. If it is determined that employed students' workloads are in excess of four (4) hours per day and are a major contributing factor to their lack of academic progress, the principal or designee will counsel these students and will caution them that such work may impede normal progression toward earning a high school diploma.

III. Credit Requirements

A. Period of Eligibility to Earn Credits

Generally, credit towards high school graduation will be earned in grades nine (9) through twelve (12). However, unless requested otherwise by the student and the student's family, the district will award high school credit towards fulfilling graduation requirements to a student who has completed high school courses while in seventh (7th) or eighth (8th) grade if one of the following applies:

1. The course was taken with high school students, and the student successfully passed the same course requirements, and examinations as the high school students enrolled in the class; or

2. The course taught at the middle school level has been determined by the district to be similar or equivalent to a course taught at the high school level.

B. Students who have taken, and successfully completed, high school courses under the above circumstances shall not be required to take an additional competency examination or perform any other additional assignment to receive credit.

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C. At the request of the student and the student's parent or guardian, high school credit earned before high school may be transcribed with a non-numerical grade, such as "pass" or "credit." A non-numerical grade will not be included in the student's high school grade point average (GPA) calculations. High school credit earned prior to high school and transcribed with a non-numerical grade will apply to fulfilling high school graduation requirements.

D. Before the end of eleventh (11th) grade, a student and the student's parent or guardian must inform the school if they do not want credit for the course or courses taken before attending high school or if they want the credit to be transcribed with a non-numerical grade.

E. Credit for applicable courses taken in grades seven (7) and eight (8) will be calculated as follows:

1. Students must complete two (2) years of foreign language at the middle school to receive one (1.0) credit. No partial credit is given; and

2. Students who participate in VPS Dual/Language Immersion Programs may apply to receive up two (2) credits if they successfully complete level three (3) of the target program language in high school. No partial credit is given.

F. Awarding of High School Credit

The district will award high school credit for successful completion of a specified unit of study. A student successfully completes a specified unit of study by doing one of the following:

1. Earning a passing grade according to the district's grading policy;

2. Demonstrating proficiency or mastery of content standards as determined by the district (the district will establish a process for determining proficiency or mastery for credit bearing courses of study); or

3. Successfully completing an established number of hours of planned instructional activities to be determined by the district.

G. Credits from Other Programs

The school counselor will evaluate each student's official transcript to determine graduation year fields, course title, Washington course designation, grade earned, credit earned, and grade point average. The principal or designee is responsible for determining which credits will be recognized by the district for students enrolling from another state approved learning program (public school, approved private school, or home school), or from out-of-state, or out-of-country. The district will accept credits from another Washington public school or accredited state private school or accredited out-of-state public or private school to the extent the credit matches a district graduation requirement, or may be counted as an elective credit. The district will evaluate credits from unaccredited programs or home schools as described in Section VIII. of this procedure.

I. Subject Area Requirements and Approved Courses for Classes <u>of 2020</u> and Beyond

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The following courses are approved for satisfying the subject area requirements as established by the State Board of Education and shall be required of each candidate for graduation:

Subject	**Class of 2020 Career- & College-Ready Graduation Requirements**
English	4.0
Mathematics[1]	3.0
Science	3.0 (2 lab)
Social Studies	
Contemporary World Problems	1.0
U.S. History	1.0
Social Studies (1.0 World Themes: Washington Perspective)	1.0
Career and Technical Education[2]	1.0
Physical Education	1.5
Health and Wellness	.5
Visual and Performing Arts	2 (1 can be PPR)
General Electives	4
World Language (or) Personalized Pathway Requirement (PPR)[3]	2 (Both can be PPR)
Total Credits	**24**[4]

J. Four (4) credits in English.

K. Three (3) credits in mathematics.

1. The three (3) mathematics credits must include Algebra I or integrated mathematics I, geometry or integrated mathematics II, and algebra 2 or a third credit of high school mathematics that aligns with the student's interests and high school and beyond plan.

2. A student who, prior to ninth (9th) grade, successfully completes one or more high school level math courses with a passing grade that is automatically transcribed on the student's high school transcript or a student who demonstrates mastery or competency in high school math subjects and has received credit for them may use those credits to meet the graduation requirement.

3. A student who, prior to ninth (9th) grade, successfully completes one or more high school level math courses with a passing grade and opts to receive no high school credit for that course or those courses or a student who demonstrated mastery or competency in those subjects but did not receive high school credits may do one of the following:

   a) Repeat the course(s) for credit in high school; or

   b) Earn three (3) credits of high school mathematics in different math subjects than those completed before high school. The student must take Algebra I or integrated mathematics I and Geometry or integrated mathematics II in high school, if the student did not complete those courses at a high school level prior to high school. However, the student does not need to repeat courses if the student already took the courses at a high school level.

   c)

[1] Students must complete the following mathematics courses in progressive sequence: algebra, geometry, and algebra 2 or other 3rd year math course.

[2] Or 1 Occupational Education credit, as defined in WAC 180-51-067.

[3] Personalized Pathway Requirement (PPR) are related courses that lead to a specific post high school career or educational outcome chosen by the student based on the student's interests and High School and Beyond Plan, that may include Career and Technical Education, and are intended to provide a focus for the student's learning.

[4] Up to 2 credits can be waived locally for students who have attempted 24 credits.

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4. A student may substitute a computer science course aligned to state computer science learning standards as an alternative to a third year of mathematics so long as:

   a) Before substituting the mathematics course, the counselor provides the student and the student's parent/guardian with written notification of postsecondary consequences due to the substitution;

   b) The student, the student's parent or guardian, and the school principal or counselor agree to the substitution;

   c) The substitution aligns with the student's high school and beyond plan; and

   d) The student has not already substituted a third-year science course for a computer science course.

L. Three (3) credits in science.

1. Two (2) science credits must be in laboratory science; and

2. A student may choose the content of the third science credit based on the student's interests and high school and beyond plan, with agreement of the student's parent or guardian. If the parent or guardian is unavailable or does not indicate a preference for a specific course, the school counselor or principal may provide agreement.

3. A student may substitute a computer science course aligned to state computer science learning standards as an alternative to a third year of science so long as:

   a) Before substituting the mathematics course, the counselor provides the student and the student's parent or guardian with written notification of postsecondary consequences due to the substitution;

   b) The student, the student's parent or guardian, and the school principal or counselor agree to the substitution; and

   c) The substitution aligns with the student's high school and beyond plan; and

   d) The student has not already substituted a third-year mathematics course for a computer science course.

M. One-half (.5) credit in health.

Per Chapter 28A.231 RCW, each school district must offer instruction in cardiopulmonary resuscitation (CPR) in at least one health class required for graduation. The CPR instruction must have been developed by the American Heart Association or the American Red Cross or be nationally recognized based on the most current national guidelines for CPR. The instruction must include use of automated external defibrillators (AED) which may be taught by video. The district may provide the CPR instruction directly or arrange it through community-based providers such as the local fire department. Students are not required to earn CPR certification for successful completion of the instruction.

N. One and one-half (1.5) credit in physical education.

Physical education/wellness includes, but is not limited to, wellness, fitness, life-time sports, kinesiology, disease prevention, nutrition, personal/family health, substance abuse, human sexuality, and parenting and community health. Parents have the right to have their students excused from human sexuality and must be provided an alternative to the unit of study. Students excused from physical education/wellness pursuant to RCW 28A.230.050 shall be required to substitute equivalency credits as prescribed by the-superintendent or designee.

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1. Credit for physical education may be waived for up to two (2) of the required three (3) semesters for successful participation in district sanctioned, WIAA and non-WIAA approved school-based interscholastic athletic programs or activity (cheer, dance or drill) in the junior or senior year;

2. Students must complete one (1) semester of physical education as a condition of eligibility. One complete season of participation will be required as a condition of waiver for 0.5 (semester) physical education credit. Course waivers are not credit bearing. Awarding of waiver is subject to approval of the team coach, academic counselor, and principal or associate principal for students in good standing per district Procedure 2151, Interscholastic Activities; and

3. Students must be engaged in a full course load of core academic study (no early release/late arrival). An application for physical education waiver must be completed during the year of athletic team participation.

O. One (1) credit in career and technical education.

1. A career and technical education credit is a credit resulting from a course in a career and technical education program or an occupational education credit; and

2. A student who earns credit through a career and technical education course determined by the district or by the Office of the Superintendent of Public Instruction (OSPI) to be equivalent to a non-career and technical education core course will not be required to pass a course in the non-career and technical education subject to earn a credit in that subject. The student earns one (1) credit while meeting two (2) graduation requirements, a career and technical education requirement and the non-career and technical education subject requirement. The total number of credits required for graduation remain unchanged, and the student will need to earn an additional elective credit.

P. Three (3) credits in social studies

It is recommended that World Themes: Washington Perspective be studied during the sophomore year, United States History and Government during the junior year, and Contemporary World Problems (.5) and Civics (.5) during the senior year. These courses should not be taken concurrently. Students who fulfill the Washington state history graduation requirement in middle school through successfully completing three (3) trimesters of Washington studies may substitute AP Human Geography or AP World Studies for World Themes: Washington Perspective during the sophomore year.

Q. Two (2) credits in world languages or personalized pathway requirements.

1. "Personalized pathway requirement" means up to three (3) credits chosen by a student that are included in a student's personalized pathway and prepare the student to meet specific post-secondary career or educational goals; and

2. "Personalized pathway" means a locally determined body of coursework identified in a student's high school and beyond plan that is deemed necessary to attain the post-secondary career or educational goals chosen by the student.

R. Two (2) credits in the arts. One (1) of the two (2) arts credits may be replaced with a personalized pathway requirement.

S. Four (4) elective credits.

T. Sequential Requirement for English, Mathematics, and Science

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1. English, mathematics, and science courses that are required for graduation shall not be applied toward the subject area requirements in RCW 28A.230.090 at a rate exceeding one (1) credit per year. The principal may make exceptions for students:

   a) Who transfer from out-of-state who have already earned five (5) or more credits but who will not be able to make normal progress toward graduation with their class without an exception; and

   b) Who fail a course and jointly enroll in the failed course and another course in the same subject area if such other course does not require the failed course as a prerequisite and the students are not able to make normal progress toward graduation with their class without an exception.

2. The 3rd year of math and science are chosen by the student based on the student's interest and high school and beyond plan, and approved by the parent or guardian, or if the parent or guardian is unavailable, the school counselor or principal (RCW 28A.230.090).

U. Credit for approved online provider courses may be granted with a two (2) credit limit. Approved course providers have met a minimum qualification and assurances to meet Washington State learning requirements pursuant to WAC 392-502. The following requirements must be met:

1. Prior permission has been granted by the principal;

2. The program fits the educational plan submitted by the student; and

3. Upon completion of the course, the student will submit the final grade to the principal so that the credit may be recorded on the student's permanent transcript.

IV. Running Start

A. The Running Start program allows high school juniors and seniors to attend community college classes (100 level or above) for part or all of their schedule. Students must be of junior standing or above to be eligible for the program. Students earn college credit, which is also converted and applied to their high school transcript.

B. In order to enroll in the Running Start program, students need to do the following:

1. Check with their high school counselor and/or determine the options for demonstrating college level placement via assessments or courses taken. At a minimum, college-level skills scores in reading and writing are required. Students may also qualify based on Smarter Balanced Assessment (SBA) or by having a 2.75 cumulative GPA or higher.

2. Speak with their counselor to assess credits needed for graduation, then decide which courses they would like to take at the college. Note that part-time Running Start students will need to coordinate college classes so that they do not interfere with their high school classes. Full-time Running Start students will generally not be enrolled in courses at the high school, even when the community college they attend is not in session. A student enrolled full-time at a college may use .2 FTE to enroll at the high school for the purpose of accessing college courses online. Student are permitted to enroll in a combined annual average of 1.2 FTE between the high school and the college.

3. Obtain a Running Start verification form from the college or their high school counselor. Work with the high school counselor and/or college to verify course decisions and coverage to tuition via state funding for selected courses. Parent consent is required if the student is under eighteen (18) years old.

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4. Register for classes via the college's online registration system. First time Running Start students will need to enroll in the college before completing the registration process. The verification process in "C" needs to occur to ensure state funding for college courses.

5. Work with the school counselor to ensure transmission of the authorization form to the college prior to established deadlines to ensure continued enrollment.

V. College in the High School

A. The college in the high school program is a dual credit program located on a high school campus or in a high school environment in which a high school student may earn both college credit and high school credit by achieving a passing grade in a college level course. A college in the high school program will be governed by a local contract which will include qualifications for student to enroll in the program.

B. Additionally, applicable information regarding student in the program includes the following:

1. Students who have not yet received a high school diploma, and are eligible to be in the ninth, tenth, eleventh or twelfth grades may participate in the high school in the college program; and

2. Student will receive credit for the courses they complete. If a student completes a course for which there is not a comparable course with the district, then an administrator will determine how many credits the student will receive for the course. Such a determination shall be issued in writing by an administrator prior to the student beginning the course.

C. Students may be required to pay a tuition fee to receive college credit for a course. Students will not be required to pay a tuition fee for high school credit.

VI. Credit for Work Experience

The district regards certain work experience as a part of the secondary school curriculum that may support a student's educational program. The district may grant credit for work experience for students who are legally eligible for paid employment and are at least sixteen (16) years old through career and technical education (CTE) worksite learning and elective credit for paid work experience.

A. Career and Technical Education (CTE) Worksite Learning.

1. The school will supervise the worksite learning experience;

2. The worksite learning experience will specifically relate to the student's CTE pathway;

3. The worksite learning experience will provide a varied job experience that facilitates student growth;

4. The worksite learning coordinator and employer collaborate to develop the student's training plan, and document paid work hours;

5. The district may grant one (1) credit for not less than one hundred eighty (180) hours for instructional work based learning experience and not less than three hundred sixty (360) hours of cooperative work based learning experience through CTE worksite learning. A maximum of two (2) credits may be earned each year for CTE worksite learning;

6. The program standards and procedures align with the state career and technical work based learning standards; and

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7. Credits earned from work experience through CTE worksite learning do not restrict students from earning additional credits through elective credit for paid work experience.

B. Elective Credit for Paid Work Experience.

1. Students must submit a proposal for elective credit for paid work experience that aligns with the state requirements and must be approved in advance by the principal or designee ;

2. The approved plan must describe how the paid work experience will develop the student's knowledge and skills necessary to meet the goals of basic education, including those essential to understanding the importance of work and finance and how performance, effort, and decisions directly affect future career and educational opportunities; how the student will demonstrate grade-level growth and proficiency in the state financial education learning standards for employment and income or financial decisions; and identify a work-based sponsor who will supervise the student during employment;

3. The student's high school and beyond plan must be updated to reflect the paid work experience;

4. The district may grant one-half (0.5) elective credit for not less than one hundred eighty (180) hours of paid work experience. A maximum of two (2) credits may be earned throughout high school for elective credit for paid work experience. The hours worked may occur during a student's school day or outside of the regular school calendar;

5. The district will verify the number of paid work hours at least once per term; and

6. Credits earned through elective credit for paid work experience do not restrict students from earning additional credits from work experience through CTE worksite learning.

VII. National Guard High School Career Training

The district may grant credit for National Guard high school career training in lieu of either required or elective high school credits. Approval by the district will be obtained prior to a student's participation in a National Guard training program as follows:

A. MIL Form 115 or an equivalent form provided by the National Guard will be completed and filed with the school district;

B. The number of credits toward high school graduation to be granted will be calculated, agreed upon by the student, and an authorized representative of the school district, and such agreement noted on MIL Form 115 or such equivalent form; and

C. The district may grant credit toward high school graduation upon certification by a National Guard training unit commander that the student has met all program requirements.

VIII. Foreign Study -- Credit for -- Responsibilities Outlined

A. An official transcript, or some other such official document, of courses taken and credits earned must be provided by the local high school officials, from the foreign school, for the purpose of local evaluation.

B. The transcript, or some other such official document, should include data pertinent to the student's period of attendance, record of attendance, and interpretation of grades given.

C. Provision of course descriptions, from the foreign school, by the student are strongly urged for assisting the local school officials in interpreting and evaluating transcript information.

D. Credit will be allowed where earned.

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E. Credit will be computed for the purpose of meeting local high school graduation requirements, by the number of class meetings per week and the number of minutes per each class meeting, in relation to the state and regional accreditation association's standards. A credit/no credit grading system may be utilized when difficulty exists in matching Vancouver Public Schools' requirements with foreign country transcripts.

IX. Home School Credit

Guidelines for granting high school credit for home schooling are as follows:

A. To gain credit for a course of study, a student will provide:

1. Syllabus or list of standards;
2. Student work sample for each standard;
3. Test samples and scores for the course;
4. Standardized test results;
5. Instructional time required for the course; and
6. Student time required for the course.

B. Once approved, these courses and associated credit will be added with a credit ("CR") grade to the student's permanent transcript.

C. Credit is granted for Community colleges, vocational-technical institutes, four (4) year colleges and universities, and approved private schools in the State of Washington.

X. Transfer from a Non-Accredited High School

A. Students wishing to enroll in the Vancouver Public Schools after having attended a non-accredited high school must meet the following conditions to be considered placed at the level at which the student would have been placed if attending an accredited high school. These conditions of placement in the accredited school system shall also apply to the student graduating the year the student anticipated graduation in the non-accredited school.

1. The student must have reenrolled in the accredited system no later than the commencement of the next regular school year, following the last day of attendance at the non-accredited high school;
2. The student must possess the ability to perform academically at a passing level at the grade level of placement;
3. The student must have earned credits following reentry to the accredited school system at the normal rate; and
4. The student must have commenced and satisfactorily completed the last full year immediately preceding high school graduation at the public high school, or a combination of public high schools.

B. A student requesting such placement must make an appointment to meet with the principal or designee of the assigned school. A conference will be held with the student and parent to discuss the process for determining the grade level placement.

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C. The principal or designee will make the final decision regarding placement of the student based on the following:

1. A copy of the student's high school transcript from the non-accredited school; and

2. Any standardized assessments or other relevant information.

D. A student entering from a non-accredited high school shall be provided with a written plan listing the courses and requirements the student must take in order to graduate;

1. The plan may be modified each semester or on an annual basis to reflect which courses have been completed as well as those remaining to be taken;

2. The student shall be enrolled as a full-time student until graduation requirements are met; and

3. Where possible, the courses into which the student will be scheduled shall include core subjects and vocational elective courses appropriate to the student's needs and interests.

4. Upon entry to the school:

a) A student must follow normal progress to graduation; or

b) Normal progress towards graduation allows for loss of one-half (0.5) elective credit per year without jeopardizing the possibility of graduation. In addition, the student will be considered to have attained senior status if, during the senior year, the student fails no more than one-half (0.5) credit in the required courses. In such cases, the student will be allowed to participate in the graduation ceremony but must make up the remaining half credit prior to receiving a diploma.

E. All requests for entry to a high school or program from a non-accredited high school will be handled on a case-by-case basis.

F. Class standing and grade point average shall be computed on the basis of academic work completed after entry into an accredited institution.

XI. Demonstration of Clearly Identified Competencies – Credit For

A. Principals may grant credit for alternative demonstration of clearly identified district and state competencies deemed equivalent by OSPI. A plan for alternative demonstration (e.g. proficiency assessment) shall be approved by the superintendent or designee in advance of demonstration of competencies.

B. Students who have failed high school courses required for graduation but demonstrated proficiency of the course content and skills through meeting standard on the high school statewide assessment may recover course credit in lieu of receiving elective credit in the following manner:

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Assessment	Previously Failed Course Eligible for Retrieval	Amount of Credit Received
High School Smarter Balanced ELA—Graduation Cut Score	English 9 or English 10	Up to 1.0
High School Smarter Balanced Math—Graduation Cut Score	Algebra or Geometry	Up to 1.0
High School Washington Comprehensive Assessment of Science—Cut Score of 3 or higher	Environmental Science, Biology, Chemistry, or Physics	Up to 1.0
or		
English ACT of 14+	English 9 or English 10	Up to 1.0
Math ACT of 16+	Algebra or Geometry	Up to 1.0
SAT of 410+ Evidence-Based Reading and Writing	English 9 or English 10	Up to 1.0
SAT of 430+ Math	Algebra or Geometry	Up to 1.0

C. Administrators may grant credit for alternative demonstration of clearly identified competencies.

1. In cases wherein teachers have identified a few standards or competencies as being missing, a Multi-Tiered System of Support (MTSS) team may recommend credit recovery through the higher level courses.

2. However, in cases wherein students are missing the majority of standards or competencies, a credit recovery course is recommended.

D. Conditions for Application of Competency Credit

1. Students must earn a C- or higher in the higher level course in order to earn lower level credit;

2. Students will earn a CR grade in the lower level recovered course;

3. The previous F grade will be zeroed out in the GPA calculation; and

4. Credit recovery courses DO NOT apply.

The following courses are available for competency credit upon completion of higher level courses:

Courses available for Higher Course (HC) completion competency credit	Upon completion of:	Amount of credit received
English 9 HC	English 10	Up to 1.0
English 10 HC	English 11	Up to 1.0
English 11 HC	English 12	Up to 1.0
Algebra HC	Algebra 2	Up to 1.0
Geometry HC	MOWWM	Up to 1.0
Algebra 2 HC	Bridge to College Math	Up to 1.0
World Language 1	World Language 2	Up to 1.0
World Language 2	World Language 3	Up to 1.0
World Language 3	World Language 4	Up to 1.0

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Environmental Science	1.0 Biology OR Chemistry OR Physics	Up to .5
Biology	1.0 Anatomy & Physiology, OR Zoology	Up to .5
Environmental Science, Biology, OR Chemistry	1.0 AP or IB Science Course	Up to 1.0
Environmental Science, Biology, OR Chemistry	1.0 AP or IB Science Course	Up to 1.0
Horticulture	Advanced Horticulture	Up to 1.0
Natural Resources	Advanced Natural Resources	Up to 1.0

E. A maximum of one (1) high school subject area credit will be awarded when a student passes a standardized high school general educational development certificate (GED) test in the subject matter. Additional credits may be awarded if the student has completed a course(s) of study to prepare for the test.

Assessment	**Initial Credit or Credit Retrieval**	**Amount of Credit Received**
GED Reasoning Through Language Arts	English/Literature (juniors and seniors)	Up to 1.0
GED Mathematical Reasoning Test	General Applied Mathematics	Up to 1.0
GED Science	Science General	Up to 1.0
	World Language	Up to 1.0
	Social Studies	Up to 1.0

XII. Credit Recovery Courses – Credit For

A. Credit recovery courses are designed to help student recover credit deficiencies and include but are not limited to summer school and evening courses;

B. Students enrolled in the district's credit recovery program may have credits earned for high school completion; and

C. The student must have prior approval and be registered through the high school.

XIII. High School and Beyond Plan Requirement

A. Each student must have a high school and beyond plan to guide the student's high school experience and inform course taking that is aligned with the student's goals for education or training and career after high school.

B. High school and beyond plans must be initiated for students during the seventh (7th) or eighth (8th) grade to guide their high school experience and prepare them for postsecondary education or training and their careers. In preparation for initiating a high school and beyond plan, each student will first be administered a career interest and skills inventory that will help inform the student's ninth grade course taking and initial identification of education and career goals. Students must create their plans in cooperation with parents or guardians and school staff. School staff will work to update students' plans as necessary based on their changing interests, goals, and needs.

C. All high school and beyond plans will, at a minimum, include the following:

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1. Identification of career goals, aided by a skills and interest assessment;

2. Identification of educational goals;

3. Identification of dual credit programs and the opportunities they create for students, including eligibility for automatic enrollment in advanced classes under RCW 28A.320.195, Career and Technical Education programs, Running Start programs, AP courses, International Baccalaureate programs, and college in the high school programs;

4. Information about the college bound scholarship program established in RCW 28B.118; and

5. A four (4) year plan for course completion that does the following:

   a) Includes information about options for satisfying state and local graduation requirements;

   b) Satisfies state and local graduation requirements;

   c) Aligns with the student's secondary and postsecondary goals, with can include education, training, and career;

   d) Identifies course sequences to inform academic acceleration, as described in RCW 28A.320.195, that include dual credit courses or programs and are aligned with the student's goals;

   e) Includes information about the college bound scholarship program;

   f) Evidence that the student has received the following information on federal and state financial aid programs that help pay for the costs of a postsecondary program; and

   g) Documentation necessary for completing financial aid applications, including at minimum the free application for federal student aid (FAFSA) or the Washington application for state financial aid (WASFA) including information regarding:

      i. Application timelines and submission deadlines;

      ii. The importance of submitting applications early;

      iii. Information specific to students who have been in foster care;

      iv. Information specific to students who are, or are at risk of being, homeless;

      v. Information specific to students whose family member or guardians will be required to provide financial and tax information necessary to complete the application;

      vi. Opportunities to participate in sessions that assist students and, when necessary, their family members or guardians, fill out financial aid applications;

      vii. Information provided on the Washington student achievement council website concerning each of the state and federal financial aid applications in this subsection; and

      viii. Information on college bound scholarship application and eligibility.

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D. By the end of the twelfth (12th) grade, a current resume or activity log that provides a written compilation of the student's education, any work experience, and any community service and how the school district has recognized the community service.

E. Students who have not earned a score of level three (3) or four (4) on the middle school math state assessment must include in their plan taking math courses in ninth (9th) and tenth (10th) grade.

F. For students who have not earned a level three (3) or four (4) on their middle school English language arts exam or their middle school science exam, the district will inform them of supports and courses that will address their learning needs and be considered in their course-taking plans.

G. For students meeting graduation requirements, their high school and beyond plans should be used to guide their choices of what their third credit of high school math and science will be.

H. The high school and beyond plan will be updated periodically to address the following:

1. High school assessment results and junior year course-taking;

2. A student's changing interests, goals, and needs, including identifications of the graduation pathway options the student intends to complete to meet educational and career goals; and

3. Available interventions, academic supports, and courses that will enable the student to meet high school graduation requirements and graduation pathway requirements.

I. For students with an individualized education program (IEP), the high school and beyond plan must be developed and updated in alignment with their IEP, but in a similar manner and with similar school personnel as for all other students.

XIV. Academic Acceleration

A. The district will automatically enroll students who meet or exceed the state standard on the eighth grade or high school English language arts or mathematics statewide student assessment in the next most rigorous level of advanced courses or program offered by the high school.

B. The subject matter of courses or program in which students are automatically enrolled will be determined by the areas of the statewide assessment in which the student met state standards. Students who meet or exceed state standard on the English language arts statewide student assessment are eligible for enrollment in English, social studies, humanities, and other related subjects. Students who meet or exceed the state standard on the mathematics statewide student assessment are eligible for enrollment in advanced mathematics courses.

C. Beginning in 2021-2022 school year, students who meet or exceed the state standard on the Washington comprehensive assessment of science are eligible for enrollment in advanced courses in science.

D. Students who successfully complete the advanced courses will then be enrolled in the next most rigorous level of advanced courses, with the ultimate goal being the student's automatic enrollment in dual credit courses.

E. The district will notify students and parents/guardians regarding the academic acceleration policy and the advanced courses available to students. The district will provide the parent/guardian with an opportunity for the student to opt out of participation in the academic acceleration process and enroll in an alternative course or program that aligns with the student's high school and beyond plan goals.

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XV. Graduation Pathway Options

A student may choose to pursue one or more of the pathway options described below to demonstrate career and college readiness as long as the option chosen is in alignment with the student's high school and beyond plan.

At least annually, the district will examine data on student groups participating in and completing each graduation pathway option that the district offers. At a minimum, the data on graduation pathway participation and completion will be disaggregated by the student groups described in RCW 28A.300.042(1) and (3), and by:

- Gender;
- Students who are the subject of a dependency proceeding pursuant to chapter 13.34 RCW;
- Students who are experiencing homelessness as defined in RCW 28A.300.542(4); and
- Multilingual/English learners.

If the results of the analysis required under the statute show disproportionate participation and completion rates by student groups, then the school district will identify reasons for the observed disproportionality and implement strategies as appropriate to ensure the graduation pathway options are equitably available to all students in the school district.

A. Statewide High School Assessment

A student may demonstrate career and college readiness by meeting or exceeding the graduation standard established by the State Board of Education on the statewide high school assessments in English language arts and mathematics.

B. Dual Credit Courses

1. A student may demonstrate career and college readiness by completing and qualifying for college credit in dual credit courses.

2. "Dual credit course" means a course in which a student is eligible for both high school credit and college credit at the level of 100 or higher upon successfully completing the course. Examples of such courses include Running Start, college in the high school courses, and career and technical education dual credit courses.

C. High School Transition Courses

A student may demonstrate career and college readiness by earning high school credit in a high school transition course in English language arts and mathematics. A high school transition course is a course offered in high school where successful completion by a high school student ensures the student college-level placement at participating institutions of higher education as defined in RCW 28B.10.016. High school transition courses must satisfy core or elective credit graduation requirements established by the State Board of Education.

D. AP Courses and International Baccalaureate Programs

A student may demonstrate career and college readiness by doing either 1 or 2 below:

1. Earning high school credit with a grade of C+ or higher in each term in the following Advanced Placement, or International Baccalaureate, courses in English language arts and mathematics.

   a) English language arts courses:

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i. AP courses: English literature and composition, macroeconomics, microeconomics, psychology, United States history, world history, United States government and politics, or comparative government and politics; or

ii. International Baccalaureate courses: individuals and societies courses or English language and literature courses.

b) Mathematics courses:

i. AP courses: statistics, computer science A, computer science principles, or calculus; or

ii. International Baccalaureate courses: any International Baccalaureate mathematics course.

2. Achieving the following scores on the following exams:

a) Score a three (3) or higher on AP exams in one of the English language arts and one of the mathematics courses identified above; or

b) Score a four (4) or higher on International Baccalaureate exams in one (1) of the English language arts and one (1) of the mathematics courses identified above.

3. A student may demonstrate career and college readiness by earning high school credit, with a C+ grade, or receiving a three (3) or higher on the AP exam, or equivalent, in AP or, International Baccalaureate, courses in English language arts and mathematics; or receiving a four (4) or higher on international baccalaureate exams.

4. For English language arts, successfully completing any of the following courses meets the standard: AP microeconomics, AP psychology, AP United States history, AP world history, AP United States government and politics, AP comparative government and politics, and any of the International Baccalaureate individuals and societies courses.

5. For mathematics, successfully completing any of the following courses meets the standard: AP statistics, AP computer science, AP computer science principals, AP calculus, and any of the International Baccalaureate mathematics courses.

E. SAT or ACT Scores

A student may demonstrate career and college readiness by meeting or exceeding the scores established by the State Board of Education for the mathematics portion and the reading, English, or writing portion of the SAT or ACT.

F. Performance-based Learning

A student may demonstrate career and college readiness by completing a performance-based learning experience that demonstrates knowledge and skills in a real-world context and provides evidence of meeting or exceeding the learning standards in English language arts and mathematics. A performance-based learning experience may take a variety of forms, such as a project, practicum, work-related experience, community service, or cultural activity, that result in a product that can be evaluated for evidence of the learning standards, such as a performance, presentation, portfolio, report, film, or exhibit. Proposals for performance-based learning experiences must be approved in advance by the principal or designee. The performance-based learning experience must conform to the graduation proficiency targets and associated rubrics established by the state board of education.

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F. Combination of Options

A student may demonstrate career and college readiness by meeting any combination of at least one English language arts option and at least one mathematics option described above.

G. Armed Services Vocational Aptitude Battery (ASVAB)

A student may demonstrate career and college readiness by meeting standard in the armed services vocational aptitude battery by scoring at least the minimum established by the military for eligibility to serve in a branch of the armed services at the time the student takes the assessment.

H. Career and Technical Education (CTE) Courses

A student may demonstrate career and college readiness by completing a sequence of high school CTE courses in which at least two (2) credits are earned in the same CTE program area. The sequence must either include an opportunity for the student to earn both high school and college-level credit (i.e., dual credit), lead to an industry recognized credential, or completion of a Core Plus program.

XVI. Substitution Credit

A. A substitution credit is defined as a course in one subject area that satisfies a graduation requirement in a different subject area. Substitution credit may be granted by the building principal for some courses and credit may apply toward graduation requirements.

B. Students wishing to use a course for substitution crediting must complete the appropriate application and must receive approval of the building principal before such credit shall be counted.

XVII. International Baccalaureate (IB) Programme Diploma

A. A student who fulfills the requirements for an International Baccalaureate Programme diploma is considered to have satisfied at least one (1) of the graduation pathway options and the minimum state requirements for graduation from high school. To receive an International Baccalaureate diploma, a student must complete and pass all required diploma program courses, as scored at the local level; pass all internal assessments, as scored at the local level; successfully complete all required projects and products, as scored at the local level; and complete the final exams administered by the International Baccalaureate organization in each of the required subjects.

B. A student and parent or guardian will be required to sign the "International Baccalaureate Programme Option Form" indicating that the student and family understand that the waiver from state and district graduation requirements only applies for students who fulfill the requirements of the IB Programme; should a student fail to meet the requirements, or if a student leaves the program prior to completion, the student will be required to fulfill state and Vancouver Public Schools graduation requirements.

XVIII. Students with an Individualized Education Program (IEP)

A A student's IEP team must determine whether the graduation pathway options described above are appropriate for the student. If the IEP team determines that those options are not appropriate, then the student must earn a certificate of individual achievement to graduate. A certificate of individual achievement may be earned by using multiple measures to demonstrate skills and abilities commensurate with the student's IEP.

B. The following process will be followed to help a student with an IEP graduate:

1. By the age of fourteen (14), the student will participate with the IEP team (including a special education teacher, general education teacher, parents, student, and other school personnel and agency representatives who will assist the student in achieving the goals of the IEP) in a discussion of transition service needs that focuses on the student's course of study; and

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2. As an outcome of the discussion, the IEP will include appropriate graduation requirements based on the student's individual needs and abilities consistent with the student's transition plan. Modifications to the district's standard graduation requirements may include:

   a) Attainable alternate classwork or individualized activities substituted for standard requirements;

   b) A statement of waiver for any waived standard graduation requirements; or

   c) An extension of time for the student to remain in school to complete graduation requirements. The student may remain in school up to and including the school year in which the student reaches twenty-one (21) years of age.

3. The student will, in cooperation with a parent or guardian and the IEP team, determine:

   a) The projected date by which all graduation requirements will be met; and

   b) The projected date and conditions under which the student will participate in the graduation ceremony.

4. The student will have an IEP that incorporates all issues and decisions from the above procedures. Any decision that modifies the district's standard graduation requirements will be made through the IEP process. Annually or as needed, the IEP will be reviewed or revised to accommodate the student's progress and development.

XIX. Waiver of Graduation Requirements

A. All state requirements must be satisfied except that the study of the United States Constitution and Washington State Constitution may be fulfilled through an alternative learning experience approved by the local school principal. Additionally, after completion of the tenth (10th) grade and prior to the commencement of the eleventh (11th) grade, students may have the Washington state history requirement waived by their principal if without such a waiver they will not be able to graduate with their class. A maximum of two (2) credits can by waived locally for students who have attempted twenty-four (24) credits.

B. The following procedure will be followed in graduation waiver requests:

1. The principal is responsible for evaluating educational experiences of individual students and recommending graduation to the superintendent when a student has not met requirements.

2. An individual student may be granted an exemption from any requirement in this policy if such requirement impedes the progress toward graduation provided there is a direct relationship between the failure to meet the requirement and the student's ability. When a twelfth (12th) grade student transfers from another high school, the student may be permitted to graduate with a lesser number of credits provided that minimum state course and credit requirements are satisfied and the student successfully passes a full schedule of classes during the twelfth (12th) year of school.

3. The principal determines whether to waive graduation requirements using the following procedure:

   a) The waiver option may not be initiated until the first day of the second semester of the student's senior year (except in alternative learning school sites where the process may be initiated during the student's junior year). The student must have attempted to earn required credits for graduation. Waivers will not be granted for the purpose of early release or late

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arrivals. The student and parents must be apprised of possible post-secondary limitations of a diploma earned with minimum requirements;

b) The request will be initiated by the parent or eligible student. The request should include the rationale for the requested waiver. Appropriate circumstances must be considered on an individual basis and may include significant personal problems, financial circumstances, or health issues. Additional circumstances may include the age of a transfer student entering the system, or the inability of the school of attendance to adjust its program for the individual student in order to enable progress toward graduation with reasonable timeliness and success;

c) The principal will investigate the request for waiver of graduation requirements;

d) The principal will make a determination in writing based upon appropriate data and upon conclusions of the investigation;

e) The waiver may not be granted prior to June of the student's senior year.

f) The principal will develop appropriate record keeping procedures for storage of all pertinent data relating to each waiver request; and

g) The principal or designee will notify the parent or eligible student that they may appeal the principal's decision regarding a waiver request in writing to the superintendent no later than thirty (30) days prior to the anticipated graduation date.

XX. Seal of Biliteracy

To be awarded the Washington Seal of Biliteracy, graduating high school students must meet the following criteria:

A. Demonstrate proficiency in English by:

1. Meeting statewide minimum graduation requirements in English as established by the Washington State Board of Education; and

2. ~~Meeting state standards on the reading and writing or English language arts assessment~~ Having met the ELA standard through any of the graduation pathway options outlined in RCW 28A.655.250 including the ASVAB and CET Sequence Graduation Pathways. (WAC 392-410-350).

B. Demonstrate proficiency in one or more world language. For purposes of this section, "world language" is defined as a language other than English, including American Sign Language, Latin, and Native American or other indigenous languages or dialects. Proficiency may be demonstrated by:

1. Passing a world ~~foreign~~ language Advanced Placement exam with a score of three (3) or higher;

2. Passing an International Baccalaureate exam with a score of four (4) or higher;

3. Demonstrating intermediate-mid level or higher proficiency on the American Council on Teaching of Foreign Languages (ACTFL) guidelines using assessments approved by OSPI for competency-based credits; and demonstrating proficiency using reading assessments approved by OSPI (when developed);

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4. Qualifying for four (4) competency-based credits by demonstrating proficiency in speaking, writing, ~~and~~ reading and speaking (if available) the world language at intermediate-mid level or higher on the ACTFL proficiency guidelines; or

5. Demonstrating proficiency in speaking, writing, ~~and~~ reading, and listening (if available) the world language through other national or international assessments approved by OSPI.

XXI. Graduation Ceremonies

A. If students fulfill graduation requirements by the end of the last term of their senior year, they may participate in graduation ceremonies. Each student will be awarded a diploma after satisfactorily completing local and state requirements. Upon request, each graduating student will receive a final transcript. Each student will be notified of this opportunity at least one (1) month prior to the close of the school term, provided the following conditions exist:

1. The student is on track to graduate based on high school and beyond plan, pathway completion and course credits at the beginning of the fourth (4th) quarter of the senior year; or

2. The student has completed a high school and beyond plan, graduation pathway and is no more than one (1) credit deficient and, if appropriate, has an approved two (2) credit waiver by the end of the senior year;

3. The student has made arrangements to earn the needed credit before the beginning of the next school year; and

4. The student and a parent or adult advocate have met with the principal and offered an explanation of circumstances that have prevented the student from meeting all requirements by the end of the current school year. After consideration of the explanation, it will be left to the principal's discretion as to whether or not the student will be allowed to participate in the commencement ceremonies.

B. Any student receiving services under an IEP who will continue to receive such services between the ages of eighteen (18) and twenty-one (21) will be allowed to participate in the graduation ceremonies and activities after four (4) years of high school attendance with the student's age-peers and receive a certificate of attendance.

C. Graduation ceremonies will be conducted in the following manner:

1. Each participating student must participate in the graduation ceremony rehearsal, unless excused by the principal. Each student who participates will purchase or rent the proper cap and gown as designated by the school administration and the class advisor and officers;

2. Caps and gowns will be worn in the proper manner, as designated by the school administration and class advisor;

3. Students may wear attire that is:

   a) Recognized as a symbol of a specific culture's recognition of significant achievement; or

   b) Required as religious dress.

4. Students who participate will use good taste, consistent with Policy 3224, Student Dress, in their choice of accessories for their attire;

5. Each student who participates will cooperate with the class advisor and commencement coordinator and participate in all parts of the graduation ceremonies;

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6. Students who participate will be expected to use good taste in their choice of accessories. Accessories that draw attention away from the purpose of the ceremony or are disruptive will not be permitted;

7. In the event of a violation of school rules, a student is entitled to due process as set forth in district Policy and Procedure 3241,Student Discipline;

8. Failure to comply with the above requirements or violation of any school rules may forfeit a student's privilege of participation in the commencement ceremonies;

9. In the event a member of the graduating class dies prior to the start of their senior year or during their twelfth (12th) grade year, the high school principal, at the request of the parent of the deceased student, may issue a posthumous high school diploma for the deceased student if the student:

    a. Was enrolled in high school at the time of death;
    b. Was on-track for graduation before the time of death; and

    c. Died after matriculating into high school.

10. A high school diploma issued posthumously must bear the inscription "honoris causa" and will only be issued at the graduation date of the class in which the student was enrolled.

XXII. Recognition of the Top 5% of Senior Class and Selection of Commencement Speaker

A. Students in the top five percent (5%) of the senior class ranking by grade point average (GPA) shall be recognized in the commencement ceremony. Student grade point averages are calculated in accordance with Section II A (8) of Policy and Procedure 2420, Homework, Grading and Progress Reports and students are ranked by GPA for class scholastic rank at the end of the graduating class' seventh (7th) semester. There is no designated valedictorian or salutatorian.

B. At least one student commencement speaker shall be selected from the top five percent (5%) of the senior class scholastic ranking. The selected student speaker(s) will work with the building principal or designee to write and deliver an approved graduation speech.

XXIII. Early Graduation

Requests for early graduation will be directed in writing to the high school principal or designee:

A. A review board empowered to hear requests and recommend exceptions to graduation requirements for the purpose of early graduation shall be formulated at the discretion of the building principal.

B. Composition of the review board - recommended: membership should include the principal or designee, an assistant principal, the student's counselor and two (2) classroom teachers.

C. In hearing a request for exceptions to graduation requirements (for the purpose of early graduation) the review board may require that both the student and parent(s) must be in attendance to present the request.

D. Any request for a student to be permitted to shorten the period of time for completion of the secondary school requirements for graduation must be in accordance with the provisos included within Vancouver Public Schools policy pertaining to high school graduation. In no case will credit recovery program, competency assessments, or continuation high school courses be considered to satisfy this requirement.

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E. The review board will respond to the student/parent request, in writing, according to policy provision: no less than two (2) semesters in advance of the proposed graduation, unless approved by the principal due to extreme extenuating circumstances.

XXIV. Withholding a Diploma

A. The district may withhold a student's diploma based on the student's loss of or damage to property in accordance with Policy 3250, Student Fees, Fines and Charges.

B. In the event that the district has imposed other forms of corrective action for violations of school rules, the district may deny the student's participation in graduation ceremonies. In such instances, the district will grant the diploma.

XXV. Certificate of General Educational Development (GED)

A. A person who is between the ages of sixteen (16) and nineteen (19) who has not graduated from high school shall be eligible to take the GED test in official GED testing centers provided these persons:

1. Are residents of the State of Washington;

2. Are adjudged by the principal or designee to have a substantial and warranted reason for leaving the regular high school education program. The term "substantial and warranted reason for leaving the regular high school education program" means one or more of the following:

a) Personal problems which seriously impair the student's ability to make reasonable progress toward high school graduation;

b) A financial crisis which directly affects the student and necessitates the student's employment during school hours;

c) The inability or failure of the school of attendance to adjust its program for the individual or otherwise make arrangements for enrollment in an educational program in a manner which enables the student to advance toward graduation with reasonable progress and success; or

d) A determination by the designated employee that it is in the "best interest" of the student to drop the regular high school program for one of the following purposes:

i) Enter a post-secondary institution;

ii) Enter the military; or

iii) Engage in employment.

B. Provided, that no person under eighteen (18) years of age (i.e., minor), shall be adjudged to have a substantial and warranted reason for leaving school unless the minor's parent(s), if available, agrees that dropping school is in the best interest of the minor.

APPROVED:

Jeff Snell, Superintendent
Vancouver Public Schools

Date

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(DRAFT 03-17-25)

Procedure - Title I – Parental Involvement

Title I, Part A of the Elementary and Secondary Education Act is a federal program that provides financial assistance for schoolwide and targeted instructional services and activities for students who are not demonstrating, or are at risk of not demonstrating, the state's performance standards in math, reading, or writing.

I. District-Wide Parent and Family Engagement

The term "parent" as used in this procedure means a parent, guardian or person having legal custody of a child.

The district will do the following to promote parent and family engagement:

A. An annual meeting of the district's Parent Advisory Group, the district will explain the goals and purposes of the Title I, Part A parent and family engagement plan. The district will involve parents and family members in jointly developing ~~the district's Title I~~this plan as follows:

1. Establish ~~its~~ expectations and opportunities for parent involvement;

2. ~~Develop jointly with, agree on, and~~Jointly review and receive parental input on ~~distribute to parents,~~ the district's ~~overall~~ Title I, Part A ~~policy~~ procedure and the process of school review and improvement; ~~and~~

3. Develop activities that build ~~the~~ schools' and parents' capacity for strong parental involvement; and

4. Distribute the district's Title I, Part A policy and procedure to families.

B. The district will provide the coordination, technical assistance, and other support necessary to assist and build the capacity of all participating schools within the district in the planning and implementing of effective parent and family involvement activities to improve student academic achievement and school performance. The district will identify and share evidence-based resources for the planning and implementation of school parent and family engagement activities.

C. The district will conduct, with the meaningful involvement of parents and family members, an annual evaluation of the content and effectiveness of this policy in improving the academic quality of all Title I schools. At that meeting, the following will be identified:

1. Barriers to greater participation by parents in Title I activities;

2. The needs of parents and family members to assist with the learning of their children, including engaging with school personnel and teachers;

3. Parental involvement strategies; and

4. Strategies to support successful school and family interactions.

D. The district will facilitate removing barriers to parental involvement by doing the following:

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1. Identifying barriers to participation by parents, including parents who are economically disadvantaged, have disabilities, have limited English proficiency, have limited literacy, or are of any racial or ethnic minority;

2. Conducting joint parent meetings with other programs;

3. Holding meetings at various times of the day and evening;

4. Arranging for in home conferences; and

5. Using findings of annual evaluations to design strategies for more effective parental involvement.

E. At an annual meeting of the district's Parent Advisory Group~~The district will involve~~ , including parents of Title I students, ~~in decisions~~ the district will receive input about how the Title I funds reserved for parent and family engagement are spent. The district will use Title I funds reserved for parent and family engagement for at least one of the reasons specified in 20 U.S.C. § 6318(a)(3)(D).

F. The district and each of the schools ~~within the district~~ providing Title I services will do the following to support a partnership ~~among schools,~~with parents~~,~~ and the community to improve student academic achievement:

1. Provide assistance to parents of Title I students~~, as appropriate, in~~ to understand~~ing~~ the following topics:

   a) Washington's academic standards;

   b) State and local academic assessments, including alternate assessments;

   c) The requirements of Title I;

   d) How ~~to~~ parents can monitor their child's progress; and

   e) How to work with educators to ~~improve the achievement of~~help their children reach or exceed state standards.

2. Provide materials and training to help parents work with their children to improve their children's academic achievement, such as literacy training and using technology, as appropriate, to foster parental involvement, which will include the following:

   a) Giving guidance as to how parents can assist at home in the education of their child;

   b) Holding parent meetings at various times of the day and evening to provide ~~parents~~ opportunities to ~~formulate suggestions~~provide input on and to participate ~~as appropriate~~ in decisions relating to the education of their children;

   c) Submitting parent comments about the program to the district, and

   d) Provide parents with opportunities to meet with ~~the classroom and Title I, Part A teachers~~their child's teacher(s), including to discuss their child's progress.

3. Educate teachers, specialized instructional support personnel, principals, and other school leaders, and other staff with the assistance of parents, in the value and utility of contributions of parents and how to do the following:

   a) Reach out, communicate with, and work with parents as equal partners;

   b) Implement and coordinate parent programs; and

   c) Build ties between parents and the school.

4. Coordinate and integrate parent and family engagement strategies, to the extent feasible and appropriate, with similar strategies used under other programs, such as:

   a) Head Start;

   ~~b) Even Start;~~

   b~~c~~) Learning Assistance Program;

   c~~d~~) Special ~~Education~~education; ~~and~~

   d~~e~~) ~~State-operated preschool programs~~Early learning; and

   e) Multilingual programs.

5. Ensure that information related to the school and parent programs, meetings, and other activities, is sent to the parents of participating children. The information will be provided in an understandable and uniform format, including alternative formats upon request, and, to the extent practicable, in a language the parents can understand, including but not limited to:

   a) School newsletter;

   b) Student handbook;

   c) School website; and

   d) District website.

II. School-Based Parent and Family Engagement Policies

A. Each school offering Title I services will have a separate parent and family engagement policy, which will be developed with parents and family members of Title I students. Parents and family members will receive notice of their school's parent and family engagement policy in an understandable and uniform format and, to the extent practicable, in a language the parents can understand.

B. Each school-based policy will describe how each school will do the following:

1. Convene an annual meeting at a convenient time, to which all parents of Title I students will be invited and encouraged to attend, to inform parents of their schools' participation under Title I, to explain the requirements of Title I, and to explain the rights that parents have under Title I;

2. Offer a flexible number of meetings, such as meetings in the morning or evening;

3. Involve parents, in an organized, ongoing, and timely way in the planning, reviewing, and improving of Title I programs and the School Improvement Plan; and

4. Provide parents of Title I students the following:

   a) Timely information about Title I programs;

   b) A description and explanation of the curriculum in use at the school, the forms of academic assessment used to measure student progress, and the achievement levels of the challenging state academic standards; and

   c) ~~If requested by parents, o~~Opportunities for regular meetings to ~~formulate suggestions~~provide input on and to participate~~, as appropriate,~~ in decisions relating to the education of their children, and respond to any suggestions as soon as practicably possible.

C. Each school-based policy will include a school-parent compact that outlines how parents, the entire school staff, and students will share the responsibility for improved student academic achievement and the means by which the school and parents will build and develop a partnership to help children achieve state standards. The compact must do the following:

1. Describe the school's responsibility to provide high-quality curriculum and instruction in a supportive and effective learning environment that enables Title I students to meet Washington's academic standards, ~~and~~ describe the ways in which each parent will be responsible for supporting their children's learning, and as reasonably available provide supplemental educational materials for parents;

2. Volunteering in their child's classroom, and participating, as appropriate, in decisions relating to the education of their children, including the positive use of extracurricular time; and

3. Address the importance of communication between teachers and parents on an ongoing basis through the following:

   a) Annual parent-teacher conferences in elementary schools during which the compact will be discussed as the compact relates to the individual child's achievements;

   b) Frequent reports to parents on their children's progress;

   c) Reasonable access to staff, opportunities to volunteer and participate in their child's class, and observation of classroom activities; and

   d) Ensuring regular two-way, meaningful communication between family members and school staff, and, to the extent practicable, in a language that family members can understand.

APPROVED:

_____ _____

Dr. ~~Steven Webb~~Jeff Snell, Superintendent Date
Vancouver Public Schools